understood until then. But during this train journey, I began to understand how his unwavering faith in me was finally going to help. It was only when the taxi dropped me outside the centre, where hundreds of female candidates stood and waited with their luggage by their side, that I suddenly found myself shrinking in size as I stood silent in the middle of these unknown faces, all of whom were gawking at me . . . judging me . . .

What now, Gunjan Saxena, what now?